



Slovenian / University

The Board Still Counts

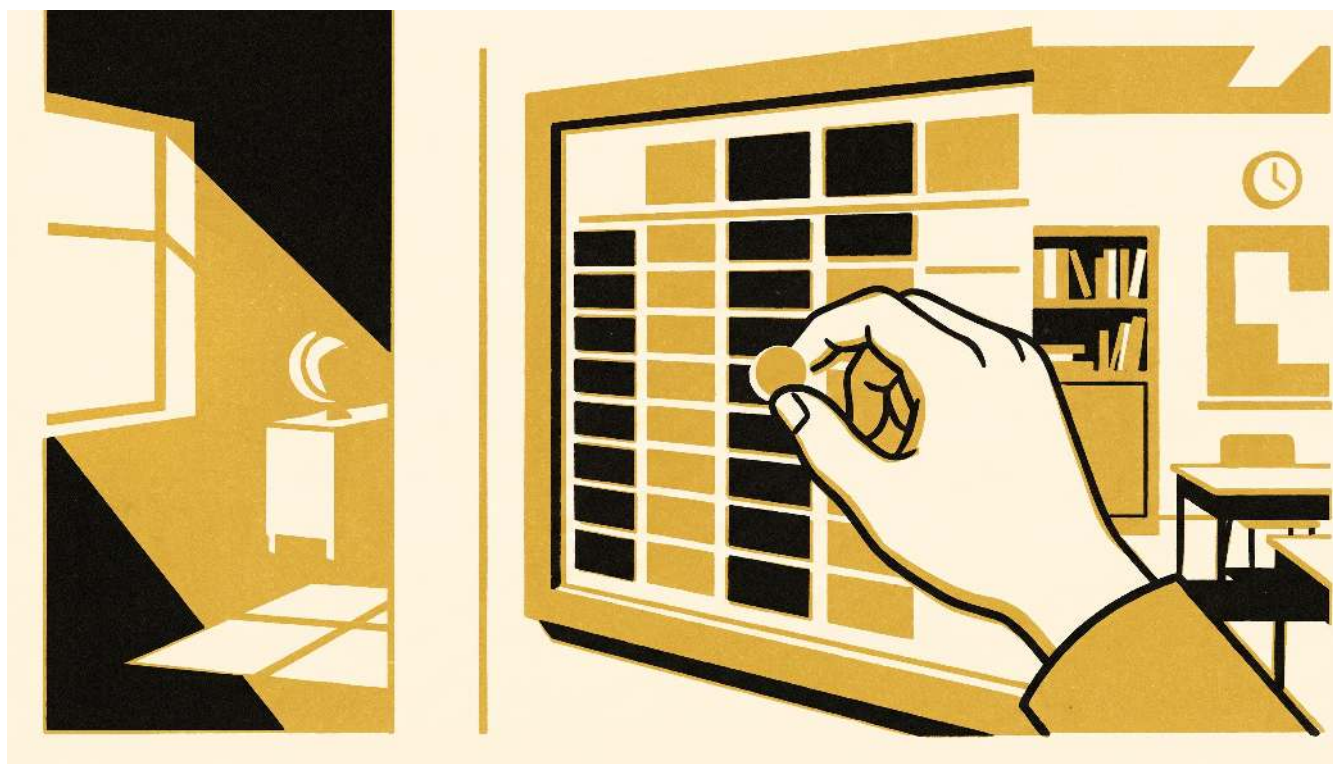
Ideas worth measuring



An invitation

A points board doesn't ask much of a wall: a printed grid, a few felt stickers, room enough for four house colours to climb at slightly different speeds. Long after anyone in the room can say what the top colour actually wins, the board keeps doing its job — steering who lines up first, who gets named in assembly, who feels, on a given Tuesday, like the house that's carrying the class. Slop University has always found that kind of instrument more interesting than the competition it's supposed to be running.

Our researchers go looking for boards like it well beyond the classroom — the fundraising thermometer outside a supermarket, the loyalty ladder behind a café counter, the tally pinned to a clubroom wall — anywhere a public score keeps steering behaviour long after its stated purpose has quietly drifted. This brochure is an invitation into that habit: into the schools, streets, and community halls where the comparison happens, and where residents are asked to sit in on it rather than read about it afterwards.



At a glance



A Board Worth Reading

Wherever a community keeps a public tally — a classroom wall, a shopfront noticeboard, a clubroom ladder — our researchers treat it as a live site, not settled furniture.



Noticing, Checked

We set what a tally counts against what the people standing closest to it would say anyway, and publish the gap alongside the agreement.



Open to the Street

The comparison happens in public — in halls, on playgrounds, over the fence — with residents invited to see how the count is actually kept.

Our research

A wall the whole room already reads

A house-points board rewards a decision nobody in the room chose: which colour a child was sorted into on their first week, years before that particular board went up on the wall. The Adaptive Metrics Lab spends less time asking whether the sorting was fair and more time asking what the board does once it's hanging there — who checks it before lunch, who's stopped checking by term two, and how far a single afternoon's tally travels before it reaches a certificate assembly.

That question doesn't stay inside one classroom. The Lab runs the same observation in clubrooms, community halls, and shopfronts, wherever a public tally keeps score of something — fundraising thermometers, loyalty ladders, attendance walls — setting what each board claims against what a visitor standing in front of it would notice unprompted.



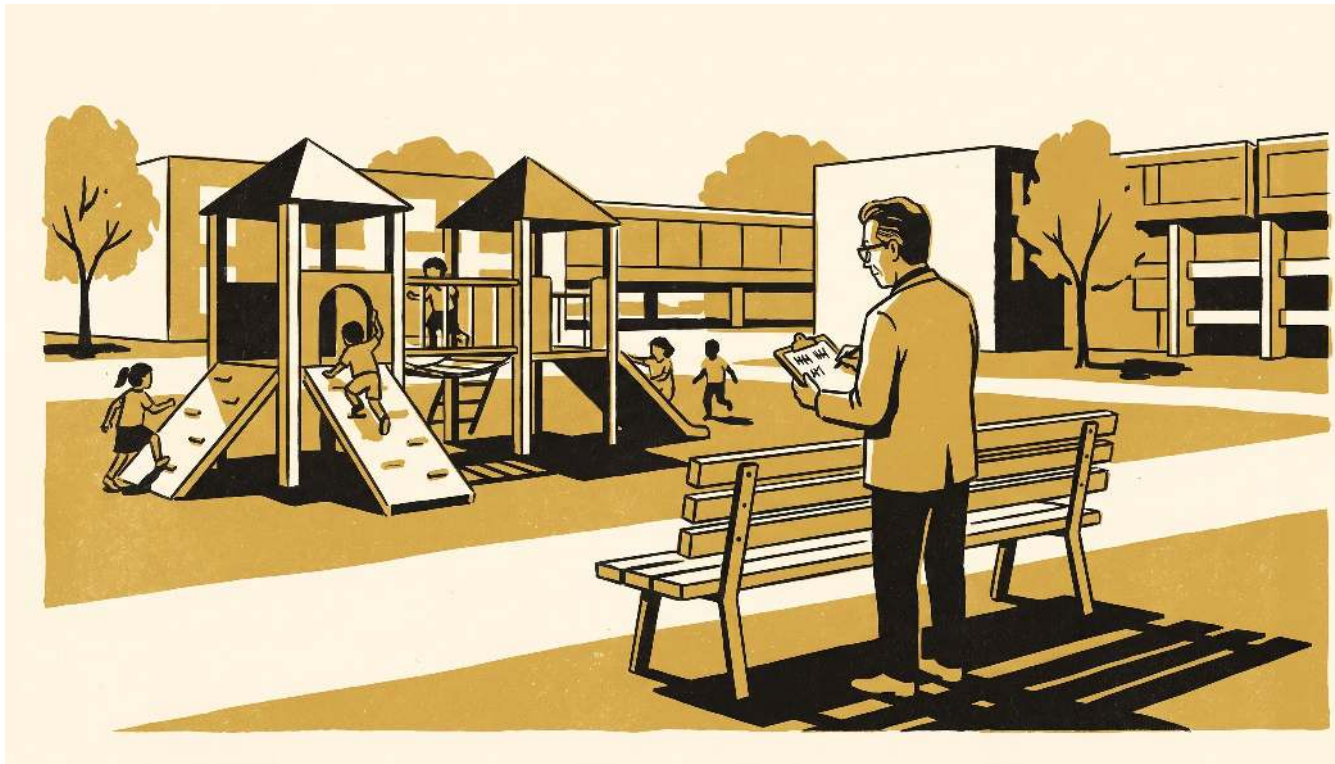
A board doesn't have to be accurate to be believed. We're interested in the distance between those two conditions, and in how comfortably an institution learns to live inside it.

— Associate Professor Casimir Beng, Lead of the Adaptive Metrics Lab,
School of Continuous Improvement

What a playground already knows

Our researchers sat with playground supervisors at primary schools across the region and asked a plainer question than the one a buddy-bench tally answers: how do you actually know when a child needs company at recess? The tally offers one number. A supervisor's own eye, built over a term of lunch duty, offers another, and the two rarely arrive by the same route.

The School of Continuous Improvement doesn't treat the mismatch as a reason to retire the tally — a board like it is easy to install and hard to argue against in a staff meeting. It treats the mismatch as a reason to keep asking who the board is actually for, published one interview at a time.



Supervisors already know which child needs company. The tally mostly tells us what an institution needs to feel confident it's still watching.

— Dr Dagny Okafor, Lecturer and Convenor, Evaluation of Evaluation, School of Continuous Improvement

The street's own priorities

Not every public tally lives in a school. A street keeps its own informal ladder too — which verge gets mowed first, which household's complaint moves a council callout up the list, whose name comes up first when a working bee needs an extra pair of hands. The School of Emergent Priorities follows ladders like that the way it follows any other, sitting in on resident meetings and community boards where a street decides, without ever voting on it, whose concerns rise to the top.

Residents are invited to the sessions where that work happens, not just handed the findings afterwards. The School's foresight work has always depended on people who live somewhere long enough to notice when its priorities quietly reorder themselves.



Ask a street who matters most this month and you'll get an answer before you've finished the question. Our job is to find out where that answer actually comes from.

— Dr Runa Adegoke, Senior Lecturer and Convenor, Strategic Drift Survey,
School of Emergent Priorities

Ideas in print

Two recent studies put the same instinct to work, on boards no reader has to take our word for.

- **What the Tally Never Asked** — Playground supervisors are interviewed about what really tips them off that a child needs company, against what their school's own buddy-bench tally reports. [doi:10.5555/slop.nuuzxk](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.nuuzxk)
- **The Fifth Tier Adds Nothing You Can Measure** — A taxonomy of the tier names printed on self-serve car-wash kiosks, checked against which wash steps a bay's own sensors actually confirm at each price point. [doi:10.5555/slop.fjgwmb](https://doi.org/10.5555/slop.fjgwmb)

The people behind the work

Dr Dagny Okafor, Lecturer and Convenor, Evaluation of Evaluation, School of Continuous Improvement — convenes the School's program on what a review of a review actually changes, and what it only re-certifies.

Dr Runa Adegoke, Senior Lecturer and Convenor, Strategic Drift Survey, School of Emergent Priorities — measures the distance between a community's stated priorities and what its everyday decisions actually enact.

Come and join us

A public tally is easiest to trust from a distance. Slop University would rather you stood next to it.

Prospective students find a University that studies the classroom board alongside the ones it keeps on its own campus. Neighbours and community groups find researchers willing to sit at the same meeting, on the same folding chairs, comparing notes on the boards that already run their street. Partners and donors find a research program that publishes what the comparison finds, whichever way it goes.

Come and see what your own street's board has been counting. Find the full record at slop.university.



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